ENGLISH B2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Gerunds and infinitives: meaning changes

Distinguish stop, remember, regret, try and mean followed by -ing or to-infinitive when the complement changes the interpretation. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use gerunds and infinitives: meaning changes to select the complement that expresses memory, purpose, experiment, interruption or consequence while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Distinguish stop, remember, regret, try and mean followed by -ing or to-infinitive when the complement changes the interpretation.

MODEL

Remember to lock the door, and remember meeting the client there last year.

verb + -ing = activity/event | verb + to-infinitive = purpose/next action

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main gerunds and infinitives: meaning changes patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses select the complement that expresses memory, purpose, experiment, interruption or consequence.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in everyday explanation, instructions, reflection and problem-solving.

Build meaning before form

Distinguish stop, remember, regret, try and mean followed by -ing or to-infinitive when the complement changes the interpretation.

What gerunds and infinitives: meaning changes communicates

Distinguish stop, remember, regret, try and mean followed by -ing or to-infinitive when the complement changes the interpretation.

The central purpose is to select the complement that expresses memory, purpose, experiment, interruption or consequence. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

I remember meeting the client at this conference.	a memory of an earlier experience
Remember to lock the archive before you leave.	not forgetting a necessary later action
Try restarting the router before replacing it.	testing a possible solution

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: verb + -ing = activity/event | verb + to-infinitive = purpose/next action. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “Remember to lock the door, and remember meeting the client there last year.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Remembered event	remember + verb-ing	I remember meeting the client at this conference.
Required future action	remember + to-infinitive	Remember to lock the archive before you leave.
Experimental method	try + verb-ing	Try restarting the router before replacing it.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
a memory of an earlier experience	Remembered event
not forgetting a necessary later action	Required future action
testing a possible solution	Experimental method

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in everyday explanation, instructions, reflection and problem-solving. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03	04
verb	-ing = activity/event	verb	to-infinitive = purpose/next action

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: select the complement that expresses memory, purpose, experiment, interruption or consequence.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits everyday explanation, instructions, reflection and problem-solving.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Remembered event	remember + verb-ing	I remember meeting the client at this conference.
Required future action	remember + to-infinitive	Remember to lock the archive before you leave.
Experimental method	try + verb-ing	Try restarting the router before replacing it.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

I remember meeting the client at this conference.	a memory of an earlier experience
Remember to lock the archive before you leave.	not forgetting a necessary later action
Try restarting the router before replacing it.	testing a possible solution

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use the infinitive when referring to a memory of a completed event.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use -ing when the action still needs to be done.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not confuse try doing with attempt to do.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a memory of an earlier experience?

OPTIONS I remember meeting the client at this conference. · Remember to lock the archive before you leave. · Try restarting the router before replacing it.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: not forgetting a necessary later action?

OPTIONS Remember to lock the archive before you leave. · Try restarting the router before replacing it. · I remember meeting the client at this conference.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: testing a possible solution?

OPTIONS Try restarting the router before replacing it. · I remember meeting the client at this conference. · Remember to lock the archive before you leave.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “I remember meeting the client at this conference.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a memory of an earlier experience · not forgetting a necessary later action · testing a possible solution

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “Remember to lock the archive before you leave.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS not forgetting a necessary later action · testing a possible solution · a memory of an earlier experience

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “Try restarting the router before replacing it.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS testing a possible solution · a memory of an earlier experience · not forgetting a necessary later action

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"I remember meeting the client at this conference." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Remembered event / Required future action / Experimental method · Gap 2: a memory of an earlier experience / not forgetting a necessary later action / testing a possible solution

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"Remember to lock the archive before you leave." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Required future action / Experimental method / Remembered event · Gap 2: not forgetting a necessary later action / testing a possible solution / a memory of an earlier experience

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"Try restarting the router before replacing it." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Experimental method / Remembered event / Required future action · Gap 2: testing a possible solution / a memory of an earlier experience / not forgetting a necessary later action

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses a memory of an earlier experience: _____. Choose the model that expresses not forgetting a necessary later action: _____. Choose the model that expresses testing a possible solution: _____. Choose the model built with remember + verb-ing: _____. Choose the model built with remember + to-infinitive: _____. Choose the model built with try + verb-ing: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

I remember meeting the client at this conference. · Remember to lock the archive before you leave. · Try restarting the router before replacing it.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

I _____ the client at this conference. _____ the archive before you leave. _____ the router before replacing it. State the full structural pattern for Remembered event: _____. State the full structural pattern for Required future action: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “I have a memory of the meeting.” using the Remembered event pattern to express a memory of an earlier experience.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “Do not forget the locking task.” using the Required future action pattern to express not forgetting a necessary later action.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Restarting is one method worth testing.” using the Experimental method pattern to express testing a possible solution.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “I have a memory of the meeting.” using the Remembered event pattern to express a memory of an earlier experience.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Remembered event to express a memory of an earlier experience, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Required future action to express not forgetting a necessary later action, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Experimental method to express testing a possible solution, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

I remember meeting the client at this conference.

Remembered event is the best match because a memory of an earlier experience.

A2

Remember to lock the archive before you leave.

Required future action is the best match because not forgetting a necessary later action.

A3

Try restarting the router before replacing it.

Experimental method is the best match because testing a possible solution.

A4

a memory of an earlier experience

The Remembered event pattern communicates a memory of an earlier experience.

A5

not forgetting a necessary later action

The Required future action pattern communicates not forgetting a necessary later action.

A6

testing a possible solution

The Experimental method pattern communicates testing a possible solution.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Remembered event / a memory of an earlier experience

The structure belongs to the Remembered event pattern. Its communicative purpose is a memory of an earlier experience.

B2

Required future action / not forgetting a necessary later action

The structure belongs to the Required future action pattern. Its communicative purpose is not forgetting a necessary later action.

B3

Experimental method / testing a possible solution

The structure belongs to the Experimental method pattern. Its communicative purpose is testing a possible solution.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

I remember meeting the client at this conference.

Remembered event: remember + verb-ing.

C2

Remember to lock the archive before you leave.

Required future action: remember + to-infinitive.

C3

Try restarting the router before replacing it.

Experimental method: try + verb-ing.

C4

I remember meeting the client at this conference.

Remembered event: remember + verb-ing.

C5

Remember to lock the archive before you leave.

Required future action: remember + to-infinitive.

C6

Try restarting the router before replacing it.

Experimental method: try + verb-ing.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

remember meeting

Remembered event requires “remember meeting” in this model. remember + verb-ing.

D2

remember to lock

Required future action requires “remember to lock” in this model. remember + to-infinitive.

D3

try restarting

Experimental method requires “try restarting” in this model. try + verb-ing.

D4

remember + verb-ing

Remembered event is built as remember + verb-ing.

D5

remember + to-infinitive

Required future action is built as remember + to-infinitive.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

I remember meeting the client at this conference.

remember + verb-ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended remembered event effect.

E2

Remember to lock the archive before you leave.

remember + to-infinitive. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended required future action effect.

E3

Try restarting the router before replacing it.

try + verb-ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended experimental method effect.

E4

I remember meeting the client at this conference.

remember + verb-ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended remembered event effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

I remember meeting the client at this conference. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses remember + verb-ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

Remember to lock the archive before you leave. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses remember + to-infinitive accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

Try restarting the router before replacing it. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses try + verb-ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____